

Multi-Shaped Governance Inherits Paper 1's Authority-Not-Labor

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Date: May 14, 2026

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This work formalizes an inheritance edge between Paper 2 (Li, April 2026) and Paper 1 (Li, April 2026) of the Coordination Knowledge Substrate (CKS) theory series.

Abstract

Paper 2 of the CKS theory series commits to multi-shaped governance: different entities in the same deployment may carry different governance configurations across three named parameters — instinct/reasoning boundary specification, content-domain with boundary rules, and applicable death types. This note formalizes the inheritance relationship between that commitment and Paper 1's authority-not-labor principle: multi-shaped governance is not merely permitted by Paper 1's architecture but structurally requires it. Only governance holding structural authority over configuration substrate content — the right to inspect, modify, and override any configuration at any time without permission or justification — has the standing to authorize and maintain diverse configurations across entities. Governance that held only labor (the procedural ability to write configurations) could not authorize divergence; each configuration difference would require permission from a system that had not itself granted the standing to diverge. The note further identifies what Paper 2 adds: multi-shaped governance as an explicit architectural commitment rather than an implicit possibility; three named configuration parameters that did not exist in Paper 1's vocabulary; and, most significantly, the evolution dimension — two entities with different configurations travel different evolutionary trajectories, such that governed diversity at configuration time produces diverging pathways over time. An operational test is provided for verifying that diverse configurations across entities satisfy the inherited authority conditions.

1. The inheritance edge

The inheritance edge this note formalizes is:

Paper 2 multi-shaped governance $\supset$ Paper 1 authority-not-labor

Read: Paper 2's multi-shaped governance commitment strictly contains Paper 1's authority-not-labor principle. Every structural property the authority-not-labor principle commits to is present and operative within multi-shaped governance; multi-shaped governance adds further commitments that did not exist in Paper 1.

The inheritance direction matters. It is not sufficient to say that the two papers are "consistent" or that multi-shaped governance "draws on" Paper 1. The stronger claim is that multi-shaped governance cannot be coherently specified without Paper 1's authority-not-labor structure already in place. The dependency is logical: remove structural authority and the multi-shaped property either collapses to a permission-requiring divergence mechanism or fails to hold across entity configurations at all.

The note proceeds in four steps. Section 2 explains why structural authority is the necessary precondition for multi-shaped governance — the causal direction of the inheritance. Section 3 maps the specific properties of authority-not-labor that appear unchanged in multi-shaped governance. Section 4 identifies what is genuinely new in Paper 2. Section 5 states the prior-art significance. Section 6 provides an operational test.

2. Why structural authority is the precondition for multi-shaped governance

Paper 1's authority-not-labor principle draws a precise distinction between two things that can be held over substrate content: authority and labor. Authority is the right to inspect, modify, and override any substrate content or orchestration rule at any time, without scheduling, approval, or justification to the system. Labor is the work of writing, curating, and maintaining that content — allocable across humans directly, language models operating under human direction, and automated cells executing under orchestration rules. Paper 1's architectural commitment is that governance holds authority; labor is allocable and is not a precondition for authority.

Multi-shaped governance, as Paper 2 specifies it, requires that governance be able to configure different entities differently: entity A may carry an instinct/reasoning boundary specification distinct from entity B's; entity C may operate under a different content-domain regime than entity D; the death types applicable to two entities in the same deployment may differ. These are not system defaults that governance can override on request. They are governance-authored configurations, written as substrate content, applying to specific entities.

The structural authority requirement enters here. For governance to author different configurations for different entities without requiring system permission for each divergence, governance must hold the right to write any configuration for any entity — not the right to request that the system write a configuration, and not the right to write configurations only

within a pre-approved range. If governance held only labor, two problems arise. First, diverse configurations would imply that some authority above governance had sanctioned the divergence, because no party would hold the standing to simply choose diversity. Second, the system would need a mechanism to evaluate whether a proposed configuration divergence was authorized — a permission gate that Paper 1’s architecture explicitly eliminates. The three rights that Paper 1’s authority-not-labor principle establishes — inspect, modify, override — are what eliminate that gate. Because governance holds structural authority, it can author entity A’s instinct/reasoning boundary as one specification and entity B’s as another specification without either decision requiring justification to the system. The diversity is not an exception to a rule. It is an exercise of standing.

This is the causal direction of the inheritance: multi-shaped governance is the intentional, architecturally explicit exercise of the authority-not-labor principle at the level of entity-specific configuration. Paper 1 established the structural standing; Paper 2 exercises that standing at a named set of configuration parameters and commits to maintaining the resulting diversity as a designed property.

3. What authority-not-labor properties are preserved in multi-shaped governance

Multi-shaped governance preserves four specific properties from Paper 1’s authority-not-labor commitment without modification. This section states each in turn.

Property 1: Governance authority to configure entities differently. Paper 1 commits to governance holding structural authority over substrate content. Each entity’s configuration — its instinct/reasoning boundary specification, its content-domain with boundary rules, its applicable death types — is substrate content. Governance holds the inspect, modify, and override rights over each of these objects as directly as it holds those rights over any other substrate content. The multi-shaped property across entities is possible precisely because governance holds structural authority over each entity’s configuration substrate content individually. If governance held only labor over those objects, configurations could be changed, but governance could not authorize the diversity itself — there would be no standing from which to declare that entity A’s configuration and entity B’s configuration are both legitimate, different, and equally subject to the same authority. Authority is what provides that standing.

Property 2: No permission required for diverse configurations. Paper 1 specifies that override actions do not require justification to the system or to a higher authority within the architecture. This no-justification property extends to configuration decisions. Governance can author different instinct/reasoning boundary specifications for different entities without requesting system approval for the difference. The three rights apply equally to any configuration decision — divergent configurations, uniform configurations, or any

intermediate arrangement — because the authority is unconditional with respect to what the configuration contains.

Property 3: Three rights apply to each configuration object independently. Each entity's instinct/reasoning boundary specification, content-domain, and death type specification is an independently inspectable, independently modifiable, and independently overridable substrate object. Governance's authority over entity A's configuration does not depend on its authority over entity B's, and a modification to entity A's boundary specification does not require a corresponding modification to entity B's. The independence is structural: each configuration object is a substrate object subject to the three rights on its own terms, not as part of a configuration bundle that must be uniformly applied.

Property 4: Attribution of configuration authoring decisions. Paper 1's governance authority structure includes an accountability vocabulary: governance actions are attributed — who exercised which right over which substrate content, when. This applies to configuration authoring decisions. Each decision to author entity A's instinct/reasoning boundary as one specification rather than another, each decision to author entity B's content-domain with particular boundary rules — each is a governed action subject to the attribution structure authority-not-labor establishes. The multi-shaped property does not introduce an anonymous configuration mechanism; it remains an attributed governance action, fully traceable under the same accountability vocabulary Paper 1 specifies.

4. What is new in Paper 2

Multi-shaped governance contains Paper 1's authority-not-labor properties, and it adds three things that Paper 1 did not commit to.

Multi-shaped governance as an explicit architectural commitment. Paper 1 allowed governance to configure different entities differently — this follows directly from governance holding structural authority over any configuration decision. But Paper 1 did not commit to this diversity as a designed property of the architecture. An architecture could satisfy Paper 1's commitments while imposing uniform configuration across all entities; nothing in Paper 1 would be violated. Paper 2 goes further. It commits to multi-shaped governance as a feature — the architecture is designed to support and maintain diverse configurations across entities as a positive architectural property, not merely as a consequence of authority that happens not to be constrained. This is a genuine addition: the architecture is now responsible for making diverse configurations tractable, inspectable, and maintainable, not merely for permitting them.

Three named configuration parameters. Paper 2 identifies exactly which parameters are subject to multi-shaped governance: (1) instinct/reasoning boundary specification, which governs how the boundary between instinct-layer and reasoning-layer operation is drawn for a given entity; (2) content-domain with boundary rules, which specifies which domain a given entity operates within and what boundary behaviors apply at that domain's edges; (3) applicable death types, which specifies which death mechanisms — functional obsolescence, lineage supersession, or capability supersession variants — apply to a given entity. None of these three parameters existed in Paper 1's vocabulary. Paper 1 had no concept of an instinct/reasoning boundary specification because Paper 1 did not introduce the instinct/reasoning separation; that separation is Paper 2's contribution. Paper 1 had no content-domain parameterization and no paper-specific death type vocabulary. These three objects are Paper 2's named contribution; they inherit Paper 1's general configuration-authority principle as the structural framework within which they operate, but they are not derivable from Paper 1 alone.

The evolution dimension. This is the extension that makes multi-shaped governance most significant relative to Paper 1's authority-not-labor. Multi-shaped governance is not solely a property of configuration at a moment in time; it governs longitudinal trajectories. The instinct/reasoning boundary specification for a given entity determines which evolution mechanisms apply to which layer of that entity. A tighter boundary specification may subject the reasoning layer to a different verification regime than a looser specification subjects it to; different boundary specifications produce different mutation governance, different pinning rules, and different directed-selection histories. Two entities in the same aspect — sharing the same deployment, operating over related content — can have different boundary specifications and therefore different evolution pathways. Their trajectories diverge not by accident but by governed design. The diversity is not just present at configuration time; it is maintained and deepened through every evolution cycle, because the governance configuration determines what evolution does to each entity. Paper 1 did not contain an evolution architecture. The evolution dimension of multi-shaped governance is entirely new in Paper 2. It is what the inheritance edge is "extended to" in this note's framing: multi-shaped governance inherits authority-not-labor and extends that inheritance into the evolution context, where configuration differences produce trajectory differences that compound over the entity's lifecycle.

5. Prior-art significance

This note establishes three specific points of prior art.

First: The architectural commitment to supporting and maintaining diverse governance configurations across entities in the same deployment is not novel relative to Paper 2. Paper

2 commits to multi-shaped governance as a designed architectural property, inheriting Paper 1's authority-not-labor structure as its necessary precondition. Any claim that architectural commitment to governed configuration diversity across entities is a novel invention relative to Paper 1's authority-not-labor must contend with this inheritance: the structural standing for such diversity was already present in Paper 1, and Paper 2's explicit commitment is a direct exercise and formalization of that standing.

Second: Evolution along entity-specific trajectories determined by governance configuration is not novel relative to Paper 2. The combination of multi-shaped governance and an evolution architecture produces entity-specific trajectories as a structural consequence, not an additional invention. Two entities with different instinct/reasoning boundary specifications evolve differently because their boundary configurations determine which evolution mechanisms apply to which layer — this follows from Paper 2's architecture without any independent inventive step.

Third: The use of instinct/reasoning boundary specification and content-domain as named configuration objects that different entities in the same deployment can hold differently is not novel relative to Paper 2. These are Paper 2's specific named parameters for multi-shaped governance; their description as configurable per-entity parameters under the authority-not-labor structure is explicitly published in Paper 2 and formalized here.

6. Operational test

The following test applies to any deployment claiming to instantiate multi-shaped governance under the CKS architecture. The test verifies that the diverse configurations across entities satisfy the inherited authority conditions from Paper 1.

Consider two entities — call them Entity X and Entity Y — in the same deployment, where Entity X and Entity Y carry different instinct/reasoning boundary specifications.

The test passes if and only if all of the following conditions hold:

1. Human authorship of each configuration. The instinct/reasoning boundary specification for each entity was authored by a human (or by a language model operating under human direction with the result subject to human authority before taking effect), not generated by the system as a default or determined by an automated mechanism operating outside human authority. An observer with appropriate access can verify this by examining the substrate record for each configuration object.

2. Independent inspectability. An observer with appropriate access can inspect Entity X's boundary specification and Entity Y's boundary specification independently, without needing to inspect one to understand the other, without scheduling or approval gates, and at

any time during the deployment's existence. Each configuration object is legible as a standalone substrate object.

3. Independent modifiability. A human with appropriate access can modify Entity X's boundary specification without modifying Entity Y's, and can modify Entity Y's without modifying Entity X's. Each modification takes effect as substrate state without requiring justification to the system for the difference between the two configurations.

4. Governance record of authorship. The substrate carries an attribution record identifying who authored each configuration — who set Entity X's boundary specification, who set Entity Y's specification, and when each decision was made. This record is itself inspectable and subject to the three rights. It is not stored outside the substrate in a manner that places it beyond governance authority.

5. No system-default override of governance-authored diversity. No system mechanism, vendor policy, or runtime layer can collapse Entity X's boundary specification and Entity Y's boundary specification to a common value without a human governance action authorizing that collapse. The diversity is maintained by the architecture until a human with appropriate authority decides otherwise.

A deployment that fails any of (1)–(5) may maintain diverse configurations in some operational sense, but does not instantiate multi-shaped governance as the CKS architecture specifies it — because the diversity is not governed diversity in the authority-not-labor sense. Diversity without governance standing is configuration drift, not multi-shaped governance.

7. Conclusion

Multi-shaped governance — Paper 2's commitment to supporting different governance configurations across entities for three named parameters — strictly contains Paper 1's authority-not-labor principle. The containment is not incidental: multi-shaped governance requires structural authority as its logical precondition. Without the standing that the three rights provide, governance could not authorize diverse configurations without requesting system permission for each divergence, and the architecture would reintroduce the permission gates Paper 1 eliminates. Paper 2 exercises that standing explicitly, names the three parameters subject to diverse configuration, and extends the resulting diversity into the evolution context: entities configured differently not only start differently but travel different evolutionary trajectories over time, because governance configuration determines what evolution does to each entity. The evolution-trajectory divergence is not an additional architectural mechanism. It is the structural consequence of multi-shaped governance applied to an architecture that includes evolution as a first-class operation.

Source papers

Li, W. (2026a). *Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems*. April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

Li, W. (2026b). *The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model: Extending the Coordination Knowledge Substrate Pattern to AI Selves under Human Governance*. April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

How to cite this note

Li, W. (2026). *Multi-Shaped Governance Inherits Paper 1's Authority-Not-Labor*. May 14, 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.